

# Paul Soteropulos

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Portfolio: [psoteropulos.com](https://psoteropulos.com) | [LinkedIn](#) | [GitHub: github.com/PSoteropulos](https://github.com/PSoteropulos)

*"Full Stack Software Engineer with 3+ years architecting and building distributed systems — from a custom real-time bidding platform to a multi-vertical inventory taxonomy serving thousands of data models. Comfortable owning ambiguous requirements end-to-end: from stakeholder discovery through architecture, implementation, and mentoring teammates on engineering standards."*

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## SKILLS

**Languages** JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Go, SQL, HTML5, CSS3

**Frontend** React, Next.js, Redux, TailwindCSS, Vite, Socket.io, custom WebSocket/SSE clients

**Backend** Django, Django REST Framework, Go (gorilla/mux), Express, Flask, Node.js

**AI/Agentic** AI-assisted/agentic development workflows (Claude Code), LLM API integration (OpenAI)

**Data/Infra** PostgreSQL (incl. PostGIS, pgbouncer), MongoDB, Redis, Docker, Docker Compose, Nginx, ELK Stack, AWS (EC2, S3), Terraform, Cloudflare Tunnels

**Quality/Process** ESLint, Prettier, ruff, pytest, Vitest, pre-commit hooks, GitHub Actions CI/CD, Jira, Agile/Scrum

**Also familiar with** Java, C#, ASP.NET, Spring Boot/MVC

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## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### Full Stack Software Engineer

| Jeff Martin Auctioneers (JMA)

Apr 2024 – Jul 2026

*Built a two-sided auction ecosystem (14-service Go/Django/Next.js microservices backend) spanning an internal staff operations platform — auction, inventory, invoicing, locations, and staff/customer user management — and a customer-facing portal for account management, invoicing, and online bidding, plus a standalone bidder-registration kiosk, as one of the founding engineers on a 4-person team.*

Work GitHub (private org repos): [github.com/ai-psoteropulos](https://github.com/ai-psoteropulos)

- Designed and built a custom WebSocket/SSE client library from scratch for two Next.js applications after determining no maintained Socket.io implementation existed for Go — implemented JWT-aware reconnection with proactive token refresh, exponential backoff, and a dynamic transport-selection layer that gated sensitive bid data from anonymous users while reducing connection overhead for non-authenticated traffic.
- Co-designed a ~35-message real-time bidding protocol with a backend engineer, driving requirements for a custom Go connection hub while independently owning the entire client-side implementation across both frontends; later led a modularization refactor to improve maintainability and onboarding for new engineers.
- Led requirements-gathering directly with company leadership to extract a viable product-category taxonomy for a multi-vertical marketplace (heavy equipment through general merchandise) from a client with no existing structure and frequently-changing requirements; designed a governance model where attribute-level edits were self-service for business staff while structural category changes routed through engineering.
- Built code-generation tooling that produces Django models, serializers, and a versioned/inheritable JSON attribute-schema system directly from a category-tree definition — avoiding hand-maintenance of 1,900+ category-specific classes as the taxonomy repeatedly changed during discovery.
- Spearheaded a code-quality initiative across Next.js and Django services — replacing years-old, partially-bypassed lint/format setups with enforced linting, formatting, and pre-commit hooks — personally rolling it out in the inventory service and mentoring a teammate who replicated the pattern across two additional services within two weeks.
- Owned the REST API integration layer connecting the primary Next.js frontend to the backend microservices — authentication context and token handling, inventory CRUD service modules, and item creation/edit/view workflows.
- Built the client application for a bidder-registration kiosk from zero as a technical proof-of-concept during the company's first weeks, implementing a webcam-based photo-capture flow with in-browser face detection (TensorFlow.js) and a QR-code pre-registration/check-in flow.
- Integrated a third-party WebRTC live-streaming service (Dolby.io/Millicast) into the live-auction frontend, building the video player embedding, stream controls, and stats UI, and maintaining the integration through upstream API changes.

- Authored and organized the majority of the team's 900+ Jira tickets and directed sprint scope with teammates, gathering requirements directly from company leadership and auction-floor staff — without a dedicated product owner on the team.
- Led a multi-repo dependency-remediation effort across two Next.js frontends, auditing and upgrading packages by risk tier and upgrading core tooling (ESLint).

#### Full Stack Developer

| Sojourn Creations LLC

2023 – 2025

Co-founded a startup building Aisop, an AI-driven multiplayer choose-your-own-adventure game (Next.js, Django, OpenAI API, custom Node.js/TypeScript socket server); dissolved 2025.

- Contributed to a Node.js/TypeScript real-time socket server powering multiplayer game sessions, including a major architectural refactor of the connection/session layer, alongside full-stack feature work integrating OpenAI's API to drive AI Dungeon Master narration.
- Set up multi-environment DevOps tooling — Docker Compose, encrypted secret management, and Terraform-provisioned AWS infrastructure — across development, staging, and production.

#### Lead Full Stack Developer

| Salish Marine Charters

2023 – 2024

- Independently designed and built a full-stack invoicing and dispatch management application (React, Node.js, MongoDB) for a marine charter/towing business as pro bono contract work, deployed to a staging environment for client testing.

#### Full Stack Developer and Instruction Team

| Coding Dojo / Colorado Technical University

Mar 2023 – Jan 2024

- Balanced a developer role with a faculty instructor role, teaching full-stack fundamentals across JS, Python, Java, and C# stacks.

#### Currently

- Collaborating part-time on [HuntSync](#), a hunting-club safety/management SaaS platform (Swift iOS, Django REST, Next.js).
- Self-hosting several personal projects on custom home infrastructure (Docker Compose, Cloudflare Tunnels, VLAN network segmentation).

## TECHNICAL PROJECTS

#### moodRING

| Creator, Designer, Developer

2022

- Built a music-based social app (MERN) with Spotify Web/Embed API integration, JWT auth, and custom image-filter-based UI components; designed and deployed independently (AWS EC2).

#### CookBook

| Backend Developer

2022

- Built the backend (Express, MongoDB, Mongoose) for a group recipe-collection app; led debugging efforts and JWT-based auth/session handling.

## EDUCATION

#### Coding Dojo/Colorado Technical University

| Full-Stack Web Development Cert (Faculty)

Apr 2023 – Jan 2024

- Faculty Instructor Mastery in Fullstack JS, Python, Java, and C#
- Perfect scores on all exams; Highest level of achievement available (Black Belt)

#### Coding Dojo

| Full-Stack Web Development Certificate (Student) | Remote Online

Jul 2022 – Dec 2022

- Immersive Full-Stack Developer Training Program in Web Fundamentals, Python, and MERN
- Perfect scores on all exams; Highest level of achievement available (Black Belt)

#### University of Louisiana Lafayette

| Sophomore, Mechanical Engineering Major, Math Minor

Aug 2004 – Mar 2007

- Relevant Coursework: Heavy emphasis on physics, mathematics, logic, and problem solving

## ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

#### Distributions Director

| Fox Press | Mandeville, LA

Jul 2020 – Jun 2022

- Managed a team of 6 to maintain time-sensitive shipping/receiving workflows and inventory accuracy.
- Reduced outbound shipping damage claims by 75% through improved packing/QA standards.

#### Trim Carpentry & HVAC Distribution

| Slama Construction / Solar Supply

Nov 2016 – Jul 2020

#### Pharmacy Technician

| Pontchartrain Pharmacy / Brand Direct Health Pharmacy

2008 – 2016

Extended job history and references available upon request.